

STUDENT NAME: OLISE JOY

PROJECT TITLE: Global Superstore

TOOLS USED : Microsoft Excel (For Data Analysis), Tableau (Visualization)

GLOBAL SUPERSTORE BUSINESS INSIGHT REPORT

1. Executive Summary

This report analyzes the performance of the Global Superstore business between 2011 and 2014 using sales, profit, customer, product, and operational data. The objective is to identify key business drivers, profitability trends, operational challenges, and strategic opportunities that can support data-driven decision-making.

The analysis reveals that the company generated **\$12.64 million in sales** and **\$1.47 million in profit** from **25,035 orders**, achieving a **net profit margin of 11.6%**. While revenue growth remained strong throughout the period, profitability was affected by aggressive discounting and underperforming product categories, particularly within Furniture.

2. Business Problem

Global Superstore operates across multiple countries, product categories, and customer segments. As the business expands, management requires greater visibility into sales performance, profitability, customer behavior, and operational efficiency.

Key challenges include:

- Identifying the most profitable products and markets.
- Understanding the impact of discounts on profitability.
- Monitoring sales growth and seasonal demand patterns.
- Evaluating shipping performance and customer service efficiency.
- Improving profit margins while sustaining revenue growth.

Without a centralized analytical view, strategic decisions may not be fully aligned with business performance and growth opportunities.

3. Project Objectives

The objectives of this analysis are to:

- Evaluate overall business performance.
- Identify top-performing regions, products, and customer segments.
- Analyze sales and profit trends over time.
- Assess shipping and operational performance.
- Examine the relationship between discounts and profitability.
- Provide actionable recommendations for business improvement.

4. Key Business Findings

4.1 Overall Business Performance

Global Superstore achieved strong business results during the reporting period.

KPI	Value
Total Sales	\$12.64M
Total Profit	\$1.47M
Net Profit Margin	11.6%
Total Orders	25,035

Insight

The company demonstrates healthy profitability and strong market demand. The positive profit margin indicates efficient conversion of revenue into profit, although opportunities exist to further improve profitability.

4.2 Regional Performance

The business maintains a diversified global presence with revenue generated across multiple regions.

Insight

Australia, Europe, and North America contribute significantly to total sales. The broad geographic footprint reduces business risk by minimizing dependence on a single market.

Business Impact

Continued investment in high-performing markets can accelerate growth while maintaining business stability.

4.3 Customer Segment Analysis

Revenue contribution by customer segment shows a clear dominance of Consumer customers.

Segment	Revenue Contribution
Consumer	51.5%
Corporate	30.3%
Home Office	18.2%

Insight

Consumer customers represent the largest source of revenue and remain the primary growth driver for the business.

Business Impact

Customer retention and acquisition strategies should continue focusing on the Consumer segment while expanding opportunities within Corporate and Home Office markets.

4.4 Category Performance

Three major product categories contribute to overall business performance:

- Technology
- Furniture
- Office Supplies

Insight

Technology delivers the highest sales and profitability, making it the company's strongest performing category. Office Supplies also generates strong profit margins. Furniture contributes significant revenue but delivers lower profitability compared to other categories.

Business Impact

Technology should remain a strategic growth focus, while Furniture requires profitability improvement initiatives.

4.5 Sales Growth Trend

Sales performance increased consistently from 2011 to 2014.

Insight

Revenue grew from approximately \$2.26 million in 2011 to \$4.30 million in 2014, indicating strong business expansion and increasing customer demand.

Business Impact

The consistent upward trend reflects successful market penetration and effective sales strategies.

4.6 Seasonal Demand Analysis

Revenue patterns reveal significant seasonal fluctuations.

Insight

The highest sales volumes occur during Quarter 4 (Q4), particularly within APAC, Europe, and North America.

Business Impact

Q4 represents a critical revenue-generating period and requires proactive inventory planning, staffing, and marketing investments.

4.7 Operational Performance

Shipping efficiency was evaluated across available shipping modes.

Insight

Same Day and First Class shipments demonstrate strong delivery performance, while Standard Class experiences the longest delivery times and highest delay rates.

Business Impact

Improving Standard Class shipping performance can enhance customer satisfaction and reduce service-related issues.

4.8 Profitability Analysis

Impact of Discounts

Analysis reveals a negative relationship between discount levels and profitability.

Insight

Higher discount rates frequently result in lower profits, indicating that aggressive discounting erodes business margins.

Business Impact

The company should adopt targeted promotional strategies rather than broad discounting practices.

4.9 Product Profitability

Top Profit-Generating Sub-Categories

- Copiers
- Phones
- Bookcases
- Appliances
- Chairs

Lowest Performing Sub-Category

Tables generated substantial sales but recorded a loss of approximately \$64,000 with a negative profit margin.

Insight

Technology-related products dominate profit generation, while Tables negatively impact overall profitability.

Business Impact

Management should review pricing, discount policies, and sourcing costs for underperforming products.

5. Strategic Recommendations

Based on the findings, the following actions are recommended:

Revenue Growth

- Expand Technology product offerings.
- Increase investment in high-performing regions.
- Strengthen Consumer customer acquisition and retention programs.

Profitability Improvement

- Reduce excessive discounting.
- Review pricing strategies for Furniture products.
- Focus on promoting high-margin products.

Operational Excellence

- Improve Standard Class shipping performance.
- Optimize inventory planning before Q4 peak demand periods.
- Enhance demand forecasting capabilities.

Market Expansion

- Leverage successful markets such as Australia, Europe, and North America.
- Explore growth opportunities in emerging regions.

6. Conclusion

Global Superstore has demonstrated strong revenue growth, healthy profitability, and a diversified global market presence. Technology products and Consumer customers remain the primary drivers of business success. However, profitability is constrained by excessive discounting and underperforming Furniture products, particularly Tables.

By focusing on profitable product categories, optimizing discount strategies, improving logistics performance, and strengthening customer retention efforts, the company can enhance profit margins and sustain long-term growth.

Overall, the business is well-positioned for future expansion, provided that management continues to balance revenue growth with profitability optimization.